



MUSIC INDUSTRY WRATH

New Victims Of Anti-Piracy

After Web sites, P2P services, even sites that offer lyrics, the music industry has now trained its guns at sites offering guitar tablature, and some have already been shut down. Guitar tablature sites offer simplified notation for beginners and advanced guitarists alike, to help them learn to play their favourite songs.

The Music Publishers' Association (MPA) cracked down on sites posting sheet music and tablature to “protect the interests of the creators and publishers of music so that, the profession of songwriting remains viable and that new and exciting music will be continued to be created and enjoyed for generations to come.” The MPA represents the publishers of transcriptions of music—usually classics like the

Beatles—and it's worried that such Web sites will run these publishers into bankruptcy. They've been on a rampage since last December, and went worldwide in mid-August. The Online Guitar Archive (www.olga.net) has shut down, and the Rob Belch, Manager of the Guitar Tab Universe (www.guitartabs.cc) laments “When you are jamming with a friend and you show him/her the chords for a song you heard on the radio, is that copyright infringement? What about if you helped him/her remember the chord progression or riff by writing it down on, say, a napkin... infringement? If he/she calls you later that night on the phone or e-mails you and you respond via one of those methods, are you infringing?”

While there is little doubt that there is some law that is being upheld here, we're wondering if common sense isn't taking a serious hit. The chances of you finding the sheet music you're looking for in a store are quite slim, even more if it's an obscure song. The



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